

Micro life

Most living things are made up of just one cell, and are too small to see. To study them, we must use powerful microscopes.

Bacteria

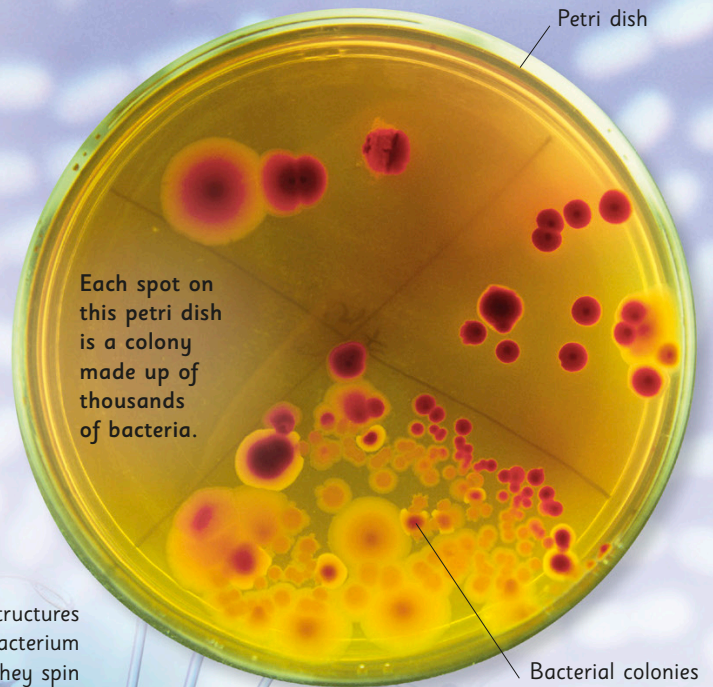
Bacteria are single-celled life-forms. They are found in the ocean, in the air, and even in our bodies. They can reproduce very quickly by splitting into two. Some bacteria can make energy from sunlight. However, most feed on dead plants and animals.

Harmful bacteria

Some bacteria can cause serious illnesses such as cholera and tetanus. Good sanitation and antibiotic drugs help fight diseases caused by harmful bacteria.



Bacteria may be shaped like rods, spirals, or spheres.



Each spot on this petri dish is a colony made up of thousands of bacteria.

Petri dish

Bacterial colonies

Whiplike structures push the bacterium along. They spin around like screws.

Thin hairs attach the bacterium to a surface.

Model of a bacterium

The cell is full of a jellylike substance that helps it to work and grow.

DNA inside the bacterium acts like a control center.

The cell wall holds the bacterium together and protects it.

Good bacteria

Some bacteria are helpful to humans. Bacteria in our guts protect us from illnesses. Other bacteria are used to make foods such as yogurt and cheese.

